

First new wild cat discovered in a century

The Tilcayo tiger cat, a small feline with a spotted, leopard-like coat, was identified in the mountainous Yungas region near Bolivia's capital, La Paz



LA PAZ, BOLIVIA: Scientists have discovered a new species of wild cat for the first time in more than a century, a Bolivian researcher said on Thursday.

The Tilcayo tiger cat, a small feline with a spotted, leopard-like coat, was

identified in the mountainous Yungas region near the capital La Paz. Locals who saw the creature in the Bolivian Andes had mistaken it for an ordinary house cat, said biologist and National Geographic explorer Paola

Nogales-Ascarrunz, who was part of the research team that studied them.

The nickname “tilcayo” given to the animal by locals inspired its new scientific designation: *Leopardus tilcayo*.

Nogales-Ascarrunz lauded the discovery as a “remarkable event, because a new wild cat species hasn't been described in 100 years.” The cat is the first new feline discovered since the Uruguayan pampas cat in 1923.

The tilcayo is slightly smaller than a domestic cat, measuring around 45 centimetres (18 inches), with rounded ears.

A pair of tilcayos — the only such creatures found so far — have undergone whole-genome sequencing, Nogales-Ascarrunz said, referring to a type of in-depth genetic testing.

A male tilcayo is living at an animal shelter in Yungas, after it was handed over by a family who had taken in the creature. A female was rescued and released into the wild after being attacked by locals.

Research on the species was published on Thursday in the journal *Current Biology*, capping off research that scientists began in 2021.

“So far, it's only been detected in Bolivia” and not “anywhere else on the planet,” Nogales-Ascarrunz said.

She said the creatures were classified as vulnerable to extinction, but their small numbers meant they could soon be considered “at much greater risk” of dying out. AFP

PUMPKIN-O-SAURUS



A scene of the movie “Jurassic Park” made of pumpkins and wood is photographed at the exhibition “Pumpkin Goes to Hollywood” at the Asparagus and Adventure Farm in Klaistow, Germany. PHOTO: AP

HEADLINES LAST WEEK

Monday is here! Let us take a trip around the world to see what major events transpired in the past week.



OPENAI, ANTHROPIC, GOOGLE TO CREATE AI STANDARDS BODY

The world's biggest AI companies are working on creating a standards body, ChatGPT-maker OpenAI said on Tuesday, as fears rise about the dangers of AI and pressure is on to create a safer version of the technology. OpenAI said it was working with Anthropic and Google on an idea that originated from a proposal by Google DeepMind's Demis Hassabis for a self-regulatory body modelled after the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority that oversees U.S. brokers and investment firms. Concerns about AI safety have escalated in recent weeks, including warnings from two workers who resigned from major AI developers amid concerns about the industry's risks. Last week, Jacob Coxon left Anthropic and warned that AI companies were “gambling with our lives”. On Monday, former Google DeepMind researcher Bilal Chughtai echoed the concerns raised by Mr. Coxon and others. On Saturday, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei called for a slowdown in the pace of AI development, a sentiment that OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, Elon Musk and Mr. Hassabis all supported.

PHOTOS: REUTERS, SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



NEET-SS QUALIFYING PERCENTILE WILL BE REDUCED TO 30: GOVT.

The Centre on September 17 agreed to reduce the qualifying percentile for National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Super Speciality (NEET-SS) seats from the existing 50 percentile to 30 percentile, even as it agreed to return 40 vacant in-service seats pertaining to Tamil Nadu to the State. Consequently, candidates securing the 30th percentile and above in NEET-SS would become eligible to participate in the special stray vacancy round for NEET-SS seats. The Centre's note said 1,857 super speciality seats were presently lying vacant pursuant to the completion of the second round of NEET-SS counselling. Further, the Centre said its decision to revert the 40 vacant in-service seats to Tamil Nadu was taken in compliance with Supreme Court orders. The court also gave Tamil Nadu leeway to allow NEET-SS candidates upgradation during the one-week special stray vacancy round.

DEFER CLASS 6 LANGUAGE POLICY ROLL-OUT TO 2027: SC TO CENTRE

The Supreme Court on September 17 urged the Union government to make the three-language policy mandatory for Class 6 from January 1, 2027, rather than “springing a surprise” on the current batch when there are hardly four months left for the year to end. Justice Joymalya Bagchi, on the Bench with Justice V. Mohana, said the court's suggestion to delay the policy implementation in Class 6 was made on the basis of logistics and balance of convenience for both students and families. Towards the end, the court even suggested that the government could make the third language optional for the current Class 6 batch, but implement it on a mandatory basis only from January 1, 2027.



INDIA RICE OUTPUT FACES BIGGEST DROP IN TWO DECADES

India's rice production is set to fall this year for the first time in a decade, and by the most in nearly 20 years, as below-normal rainfall during the crop's maturation period threatens to cut yields, industry officials told. The drop in the world's biggest rice-producing and exporting country will lift local prices and make exports expensive at a time when prices are already rising in other exporting countries such as Thailand and Vietnam. However, massive inventories built up from record harvests in recent years will allow New Delhi to maintain exports at record levels despite the lower output. India has so far received 15% lower rainfall than normal since the four-month-long monsoon season started on June 1, weather department data showed. But in some rice-growing States, the deficit is as high as 42%.



MISQUOTING JUDICIAL REMARKS CAN AMOUNT TO A CRIME, SAYS SC

The Supreme Court clarified on September 16 that while unauthorised distribution of live-streamed proceedings constitutes contempt, circulating clips featuring false insertions or misattributed judicial remarks graduates the violation into criminal conduct. A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant was referring to the online representation of oral remarks made during court proceedings. The court said falsely imputing statements as part of oral submissions made by lawyers in court was also wrong.

The Bench was hearing a plea filed by a lawyer who complained that a video of his appearance in court was circulated online in violation of specific Supreme Court orders on July 24 and July 31, which had barred the online use of raw or edited audio and video clippings of judicial hearings. PHOTOS: KK MUSTAFA, KUMAR SS



QUIZ TIME

Have you been following the news headlines?

- Which two countries finalised the course of their shared border in La Paz after nearly nine decades of negotiations last week?
- Project Cheetah celebrated _____ anniversary last week.
- About 12.5 trillion tons of ice from glaciers in Greenland and Antarctica have melted since which year, according to scientific reports?
- Which is the first Indian state to introduce a mandatory computer-based Hazard Perception Test for driving licence applicants?
- Which was the first self-governing country in the world to grant all women the right to vote in parliamentary elections?

Answers on page 3

Accepting mistakes

This week, Dr S Kulandaisamy explores how teachers can develop humility and the ability to accept mistakes

PEACE TALKS

A Teacher for Peace understands that humility is not weakness, but strength. She helps students realise that accepting mistakes and seeking pardon are essential for growth.

1. She creates a safe and non-judgmental environment where mistakes are seen as part of learning.

2. She models humility herself. When she makes a mistake, she openly acknowledges it and apologises. This teaches students through example.

3. She gently guides students to recognise their mistakes without shame by asking reflective questions such as:

“What happened?”
“What could you have done

differently?”

4. She teaches the language of apology, helping students express regret sincerely and respectfully.

5. She emphasises that seeking pardon shows courage and honesty, not weakness.

6. She encourages self-correction. Students are guided to take small steps to improve after recognising their mistakes.

7. She appreciates honesty and effort to correct rather than focusing only on the mistake.

8. She nurtures a culture of forgiveness, where students accept apologies and move forward positively.

In this way, a Teacher for Peace helps students experience that humility leads to inner peace and stronger relationships.

(Peace Talks is a series that focuses on peace education. The author is the Secretary at the Gandhi Peace Foundation. You can get in touch with him at ggfchennai@gmail.com.)
PHOTO: WIKIMEDIA COMMONS



20-MINUTE ACTIVITY FOR CHILDREN - 1620



GK Corner (3 mins)



A mahout watches over a tame Sumatran elephant playing, surrounded by haze caused by forest and land fires, at the Buluh Cina Nature Tourism Park in Kampar, Riau. Sumatran elephants are a critically endangered subspecies of the Asian elephant. Found only on the Indonesian island of Sumatra, they face threats from habitat loss, human-elephant conflict and forest fires. Can you guess the scientific name of the Asian elephant, the species to which the Sumatran elephant belongs? PHOTO: AFP

Ans: Elephas maximus.

Two-minute comprehension

Read the paragraphs below and answer the questions

Tigress Bijalee, a key attraction at Mumbai's Sanjay Gandhi National Park (SGNP), has died due to age-related ailments, officials said on Thursday.

The 18-year-old big cat breathed her last around 9.45 pm on Wednesday, park authorities said. Bijalee had been a key attraction and cherished member of the SGNP family since 2016, they said.

According to an official from the protected forest, the tigress had shown a gradual reduction in her food intake over the past month, prompting them to closely monitor her health.

She was being provided medical and supportive care by the veterinary officer under the technical guidance of the Technical Veterinary Advisory Team of Western Maharashtra, the official said.

Bijalee was brought to SGNP from the Pench Tiger Reserve. Over her decade-long stay at the park, she played an important role in wildlife management, conservation education, and captive animal care efforts, officials said.

A post-mortem examination will be conducted to ascertain the exact cause of death, authorities said. The SGNP administration also invited wildlife enthusiasts to share their memories and photographs of Bijalee on social media to honour her legacy.

- 1) Who died according to the paragraph?
.....
- 2) When and where did she die?
.....
- 3) From where was she brought to SGNP?
.....

Unscramble - in a minute

E	D	A	T	I	C	S	O	L

A verb, the word means to move (a bone) out of its normal or regular position.

Ans: Dislocate

AMAZING ANAGRAMS

The following sentences are incomplete. In each, the missing word/words is the anagram of the highlighted word/words. See if you can figure it out!

1. She may be _____ from all that running, but I am happy that she **tried** to reach 3000 steps.
2. The movie was so **lame** that when the three of them went to have dinner, they couldn't even take a bite out of their _____.
3. She was **praised** for becoming a doctor, which was the profession she _____ to be since she was seven.
4. The coach provided his team with a few **pointers** on how to get fit at home and build their muscles through the intake of food rich in _____.

An **anagram** is a word or phrase that is formed by rearranging the letters of another.

Answer: 1. tired, 2. meal 3. aspired 4. proteins

Word of the Day

- 2 minutes

SUSCEPTIBLE

Pronounced as: suh-sep-tuh-bl
Meaning: An adjective that describes the capability of one to be easily influenced or affected by someone or something.
Origin: The word is derived from the Late Latin word *susceptibilis*, which means 'receptive'.
Usage: The children are more susceptible to infection in this cold weather.
Activity: Use the word in a sentence or two of your own.

MINI QUIZ 2 mins...

Today's quiz is all about crows

1. What is the term for a group of crows?
2. True or false: the average lifespan of a wild crow is up to more than 15 years under ideal conditions.
3. What is the scientific name for crows?
4. True or false: Crows are not found in Antarctica.
5. A baby crow is called _____.



PHOTO: V RAJU

Answers: 1. Murder, 2. True, 3. Corvus, 4. True, 5. a chick

In how many minutes did you complete today's activities?



Journal Writing

5 minutes

Dear Diary,

If I were in a boxing ring, I would want my opponent to be...

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

FACTS AND FRAMES

Know your idioms

It's time to spruce up your language!
Let's read idioms and phrases based
all on "being too late".



This idiom means that there is not enough of something and that it arrived too late to resolve or save a situation. It should've been provided way earlier to make a difference or be effective.

That pit-stop on the 40th lap of the race was too little, too late to get the team on the podium.

SHUT THE STABLE DOOR AFTER THE HORSE HAS BOLTED

Imagine you have a barn and a horse is trying to get out of the stable. You move fast, you shut the stable but alas, the horse has already bolted. This idiom means to be too late in preventing something bad from happening and that the harm is already done. His apology is basically shutting the stable door after the horse has bolted, as the damage to the friendship is already made.



LATE IN THE DAY

Although it might sound straightforward to you, this idiom doesn't really have much to do with 'day'. It means to do something later than you should and in fact, too late to be useful.

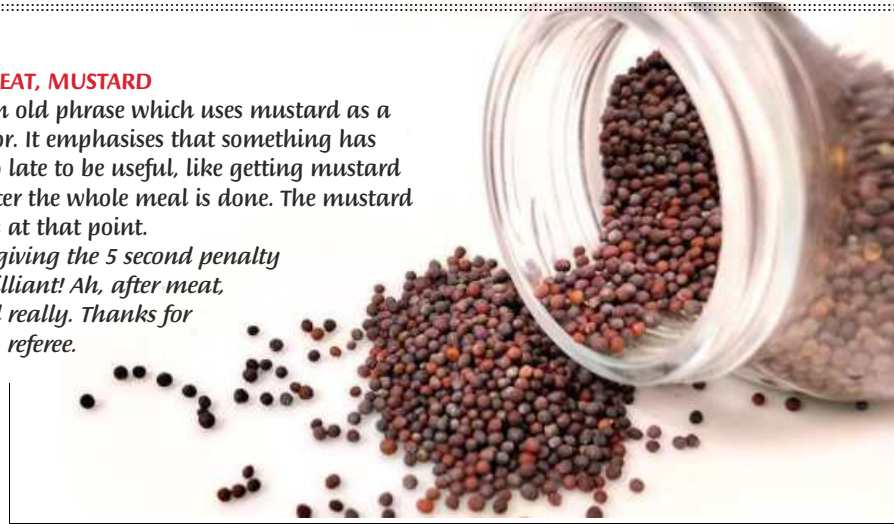
No, no, Mikey. It is late in the day for you to start looking at this data. The championship is almost over.



AFTER MEAT, MUSTARD

This is an old phrase which uses mustard as a metaphor. It emphasises that something has come too late to be useful, like getting mustard sauce after the whole meal is done. The mustard is useless at that point.

You are giving the 5 second penalty now? Brilliant! Ah, after meat, mustard really. Thanks for nothing, referee.



A DAY LATE AND A DOLLAR SHORT

This is an American equivalent of the idiom 'too little, too late' from our list. It means that something has arrived too late to be of any benefit and that it was too feeble to make an effect.

The offer that the English club made for Nina was a day late and a dollar short after all the recent misunderstandings. Meanwhile, the Spanish fans are having the time of their lives now that she's joining the Spanish League.

UNTIL ALL HOURS

Imagine staying up at night when everyone is sleeping. This idiom means exactly this: until very late or too late. It means that you stay awake too past your usual bedtime, even into the morning hours or remain active way past your working hours. *You won't find Alan here at the hotel because he will be out until all hours at the lab working on the data.*



CBSE's support programme for class 10, 12 govt schools in Ladakh

Designed to strengthen students' academic preparedness for the CBSE Board examinations, CBSE in collaboration with the Ladakh government launches an academic support programme for students of classes 10 and 12 in government schools.



Students coming out after appearing in the class 12th Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) Exam.
REPRESENTATIVE PHOTO: SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR / THE HINDU

NEW DELHI: The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE), in collaboration with the Ladakh government, is conducting a month-long in-person academic support programme for students of classes 10 and 12 in government schools across the Union Territory, officials said.

The initiative has been designed to strengthen students' academic preparedness for the CBSE Board examinations through focused, classroom-based support.

Under the programme, academic support classes are being organised in government schools across locations such as Leh, Nubra,

Shams, Zaskar, Kargil, Drass, Changthang, Sankoo Chiktan and other high altitude areas in the Union Territory from September 14 to October 14, 2026.

"The sessions focus on subject-specific academic preparation while also familiarising students with important aspects of board examinations, including assessment strategies, examination techniques, effective time management and approaches to answering questions," CBSE Secretary Varun Bhardwaj said in a statement.

"Over 250 experienced teachers

and resource persons from CBSE-affiliated schools across the country have been nominated to conduct the sessions and provide focused academic guidance to the students," he added.

The CBSE official explained that the board aims to strengthen conceptual understanding, enhance examination preparedness and provide students with targeted academic support in a classroom environment.

"The programme is also expected to contribute towards improved learning outcomes among students of Government schools in the Union Territory of Ladakh," he added. PTI

TODAY'S QUIZ: ANSWERS

1. Bolivia and Paraguay
2. fourth
3. 1979
4. Keralam
5. New Zealand

LEARNING TREE

What is dermatology?

Dermatology is the branch of medicine that studies, diagnoses, and treats problems affecting the skin, hair, and nails.



On September 20, 1954, the first successful test compilation and execution of a computer program using Fortran took place. Built by a team of pioneers in computer programming and led by John Backus, it wasn't until 1957 that Fortran was finally ready. Time to pull out the punch cards to hand you the story of Backus and what he built...

A.S.Ganesh
ganesh.a.s.@thehindu.co.in



One of the oldest high-level computer programming languages, Fortran was designed mainly for numerical and scientific computing. As a general-purpose compiler, it is hugely significant as it made programming more accessible to people.

months later "because all you had to do was memorise stuff." He had another operation on his head to replace the plate with one he made himself and left the army in 1946 with an honourable medical discharge.

Just before his graduation in 1949, Backus found himself wandering into IBM's headquarters on New York's Madison Avenue one day. There, the Selective Sequence Electronic Computer (SSEC) — a one-of-a-kind room-sized

Take this quiz once before you read this article. If you haven't got all the answers, take it once more after you've read it. Answers to all these questions can be found right here!

- 1) Name the only woman who was part of the initial team that built Fortran.
- 2) John Backus is also referred to as the _____ of Fortran. Fill in the blank.
- 3) In which year did Backus receive the prestigious Turing Award?

It was during this period that he was diagnosed with a cranial bone tumour that was removed and replaced with a metal plate. In 1945, he continued to study medicine at Flower and Fifth Avenue Medical School in New York, only to drop out again nine



The IBM 704 was the first mass-produced computer with core memory and floating-point arithmetic hardware. It was sold with Fortran and its accompanying manual. Picture shows a woman working on the IBM 704. PHOTO: NASA'S MARSHALL SPACE FLIGHT CENTER / FLICKR

electromechanical computer —
was on display.

Backus made a passing mention of his interest in mathematics to his tour guide, unaware himself that he was sowing the seeds for his life's work. An informal oral examination made up of mathematical brainteasers followed, and, owing to his excellent results, he was taken upstairs to meet the SSEC project director. A person with little-to-no idea of what programming entailed was instantly hired as a programmer. He would go on to become a pioneer in the field.

Even though it hadn't been evident so far in his life, Backus soon realized that he was an expert at solving problems. He not only had a knack for finding ways of breaking down seemingly difficult problems into a more manageable form, but also had a willingness to fail in his search for knowledge. "You need the willingness to fail all the time," Backus once said. "You have to generate many ideas only to discover that they don't work. And you keep doing that over and over until you find one that does work."

During his first three years at IBM, there were a number of instances when this came to the fore. With the SSEC tasked with the calculation of **ephemeris tables** (a table giving the coordinates of a celestial body at a number of specific times during a given period), Backus helped develop techniques for the same. These were later employed by NASA for the Apollo lunar missions of the 1960s.

To facilitate the process of writing instructions at the machine level, which is what programming revolved around back then, Backus invented

Following his work on Fortran, Backus collaborated with Danish computer scientist Peter Naur to develop the Backus-Naur Form. This can be seen as a standard mathematical notation describing the grammatical rules for high-level languages.

He also made contributions to functional programming (FP), making it more accessible and driving further interest and research in it. A system of programming, FP focusses on describing the problem someone wants a computer to solve and less on feeding the computer with step-wise instructions.

Backus worked with IBM for 41 years until his retirement in 1991 and was named one of the first IBM Fellows in 1963. He was awarded the National Medal of Science in 1975 and the Turing Award in 1977.

Following his death on March 17, 2007, Backus even had an asteroid — asteroid 6830 Johnbackus — named in his honour in June 2007.

You need the willingness to fail all the time. You have to generate many ideas only to discover that they don't work. And you keep doing that over and over until you find one that does work.

Speedcoding. This allowed operations on floating point numbers to be described in a symbolic form.

IBM was working on IBM 704 at the time, a scientific computer primarily designed for floating point operations. Aware of how cumbersome programming was and based on his Speedcoding work, Backus proposed an idea. He suggested creating a new language that would make it easier to program the 704.

Once it was accepted, Backus built a small team of 10 people that worked out of the IBM World Headquarters in Manhattan and sought to make programming better. His diverse group included a chess wiz, a researcher from the



John Backus
PHOTO:
PIERRE.LESCANNE /
WIKIMEDIA
COMMONS

“Much of my work has come from being lazy. I didn't like writing programs, so I started work on a system to make them easier to write.”

making it both cheaper and faster. Secondly, they had to figure out how to structure the underlying code to make this possible.

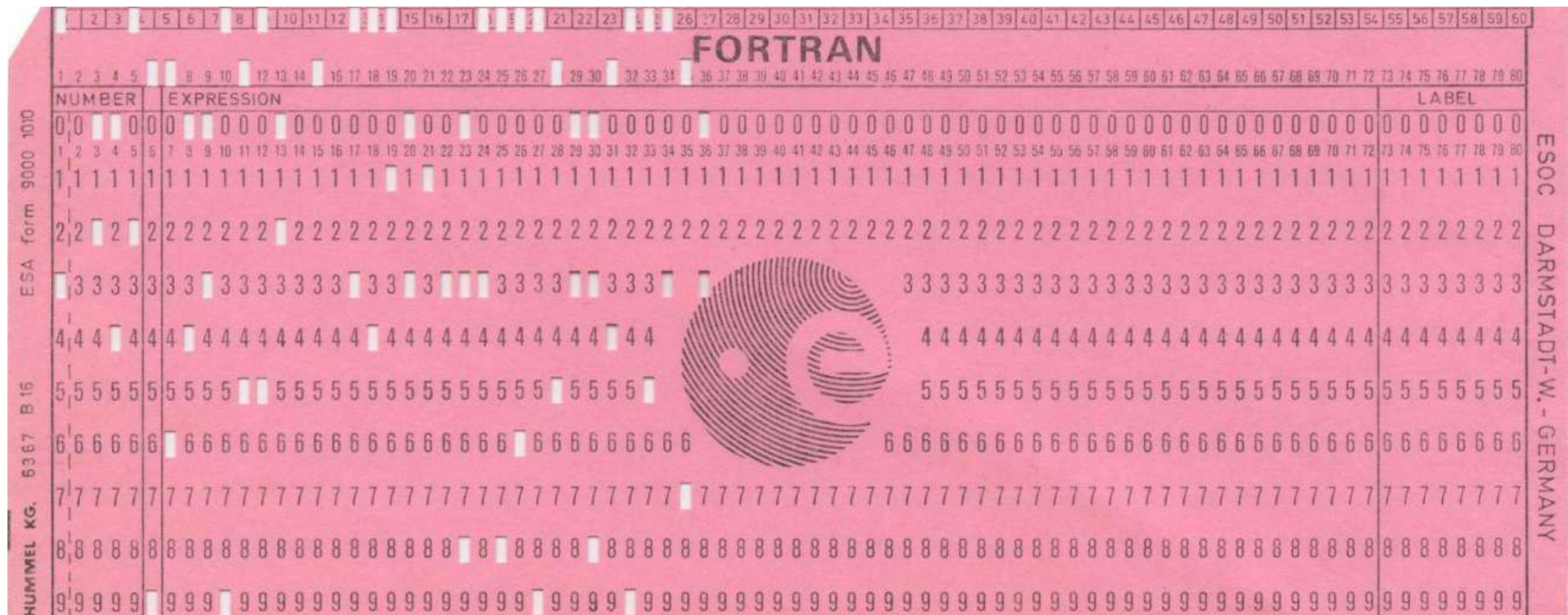
Backus, however, had another way of summing this all up. "Much of my work has come from being lazy," he later said. "I didn't like writing programs, so I started work on a system to make them easier to write."

Different people in the team might have been driven for different reasons, but they collectively attained their objective, step by step. On September 20, 1954, they had one of their first successes, as the first successful test compilation and execution of a computer program using Fortran took place. Later that same year, the team had enough confidence in their work to release a preliminary report on November 10.

The IBM Mathematical Formula Translating System, or Fortran, took a couple of years to go from conception to release and made its debut in 1957. The way humans communicated with computers was about to be changed forever.

What had until then been a tough task of manually punching in as many as 1,000 program instructions for any particular problem could suddenly be achieved through less than 100 in Fortran. **Data-laden** (loaded with data) problems could be handled effectively in Fortran, be it for computing economic and statistical models, missile trajectories, or flight patterns for NASA. Soon, every IBM 704 was shipped with the Fortran program and its manual.

For years, Backus and his team continued to tinker with Fortran until the compiler attained a degree of stability. Fortran first gained a foothold in the scientific community, before becoming the dominant programming language. Nearly seven decades on, Fortran still remains in vogue, with its most recent stable release having taken place in 2023.



A Fortran punch card used by the European Space Agency. PHOTO: TILL NIERMANN / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

reviews was not suited for his team. Not new to rule-breaking, he decided to completely ignore the whole process and offered his team the freedom they required.

As a team, they were looking to address two fundamental programming problems. Firstly, they wanted to make programming accessible to a broader range of people by

Cover of the first reference manual for Fortran. PHOTO: WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, a cryptographer, and a crystallographer. Not to be left out, the team also included Lois Haibt, fresh out of Vassar College, the only woman in the team.

Backus has their back

Right from the start, Backus knew that IBM's method of having yearly performance

ANSWERS TO QUICK QUIZ:

- 1) Lois Hailb
- 2) father
- 3) 1977

Q W I K I P E D I A :
A DAILY SEARCH-AND-LEARN ACTIVITY

THE MONDAY'S MARAUDER: LUNAR CRATER → MALVERN



Ever been on Wikipedia to search for something? More often than not we start with one topic, click a few links and within no time, are eagerly reading something else. Qwikipedia is a game that tries to quench our curiosity to learn something new. Start with one search from a specific article in this newspaper, and get started on a journey of learning with multiple clicks. Surprise yourself by finding new routes each time!



LUNAR CRATER

A lunar crater is a large bowl-shaped depression (or an impact crater) on the Moon. These craters are left behind from impacts made by asteroids and comets that crash onto the lunar surface. When astronomer Galileo used one of his early telescopes to get a much closer look at the Moon, he discovered that, contrary to what people believed at that time, it was not a perfect sphere, and had mountainous structures as well as depressions. These depressions were later named craters by German astronomer Johann Hieronymus Schröter. Categorisation and studies regarding the craters of the Moon were conducted by scientists, as well as programmes that utilised **citizen science**.



FLORENCE NIGHTINGALE

Florence Nightingale was a social reformer and the founder of modern nursing. She is known for having served in the Crimean War as a nurse trainer, during which time she discovered the poor conditions in which wounded soldiers were being tended to. The medical staff was overworked, medicines were in short supply, and the sanitation was incredibly poor. Having witnessed this first-hand, Nightingale went on to serve as an advocate for sanitary living conditions. During her time serving in the war, she was nicknamed "The Lady with the Lamp". During the 100th anniversary of her passing, a Florence Nightingale exhibition was held in the Malvern Museum. Read on to learn more about **Malvern**.

MALVERN

Malvern is a **spa town** (a town built around natural mineral water springs) in the county of Worcestershire in England. At the time of the 2021 census, the town had a population of 30,462. Many of the major suburbs within it are separated by common land. Malvern is said to be the parliamentary constituency of West Worcestershire. The town experienced its sunniest year in 2003, when 1776 hours of sunshine were recorded.



CITIZEN SCIENCE

Citizen science involves scientific research that is done with the contributions and assistance of the general public and non-professionals. The exact definition of citizen science varies with different organisations, each having its own idea of its range. This form of research can be done in many fields of study, including astronomy, information science, and biology. Within citizen science, the public and volunteers take up the task of data collection, which could involve them taking pictures of the subject of study. E.g. plants, animals, birds, etc. One famous example of a citizen scientist from the 19th Century, would be **Florence Nightingale**.



PHOTOS: GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO/ VITALY KUSAYLO, THE HINDU, WIKIMEDIA COMMONS.

So, the path we have travelled today is Lunar crater → Citizen science → Florence Nightingale → Malvern
Three clicks! Hop over! It's time for the next question.
Send in your paths for the above to school@thehindu.co.in with the subject: Qwikipedia

IN SCHOOL INBOX

Showcase your creativity

A couple of artivity entries sent in by students.

ARTIVITY

Read the newspaper and create an original artwork based on a news item that interests you and send your entry in JPEG format (not as PDF) to school@thehindu.co.in with the subject - Artivity. ONLY artworks based on current news or issues relating to Science, Space, Environment, Wildlife and Sports will be considered for publication. Please AVOID mailing other works. Mention your name, class, school and city in the same mail (not in separate mails).



Name: S Akshith
Class: VII
School: PM Shri Kendriya Vidyalaya, Virudhunagar, Tamil Nadu



Name: R Dismitha
Class: X
School: Amararaja Vidyalayam, Karakambadi, Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh

HERE KITTY, KITTY



A bobcat mother cares for her cub at Chapultepec Wildlife Conservation Center in Mexico City, Mexico. The newborn bobcat seen in the photo above recently made its public debut in the zoo in mid-September. This marked the first recorded birth at the facility. The cub was born to two adult bobcats in July, expanding the zoo's records. It delighted spectators, wandering the enclosure and climbing branches. PHOTO: REUTERS

GUESS WHO?



He is an Indian billiards and snooker player who dominated the sport during much of the 1990s. He is a five-time winner of the professional-level, a three-time winner of the amateur world championships, and the holder of two world records in English billiards. He has also co-founded Olympic Gold Quest, a foundation towards the promotion of sports in India.

Answer: Geet Sethi

SUDOKU

				8		1		
	7	6	1		9			
8					5		4	
4		9	3				6	
		7				4		
	2				7	3		8
	1		5					6
			8		4	9	2	
		8		7				

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

A mind game and a puzzle that you solve with reasoning and logic. Fill in the grid with digits in such a manner that every row, every column and every 3x3 box accommodates the digits 1 to 9, without repeating any. The solution to today's puzzle is at right.

4	3	5	1	7	6	8	9	2
1	2	6	4	9	8	3	5	7
9	7	8	3	2	5	1	4	6
8	1	3	7	6	4	9	2	5
2	6	4	8	5	9	7	3	1
5	9	7	2	1	3	6	8	4
4	7	5	6	4	2	1	9	3
3	8	2	6	3	7	1	5	9
6	1	5	7	8	2	4	3	9



Nitish Kumar Reddy.
PHOTO: PTI

Hardik and Nitish can play together: Gambhir

Coach says both can be in same eleven once star all-rounder Hardik starts bowling 10 overs in one-day format

NEW DELHI: India head coach Gautam Gambhir is delighted with the progress of Nitish Kumar Reddy as a fast bowling all-rounder and said there is a strong possibility of him playing alongside Hardik Pandya once the star all-rounder is fit enough to bowl 10 overs in the 50-over format. Pandya, who has not played any cricket since May due to a quadriceps injury, was not picked for the upcoming ODI series against the West Indies as he is not in a position to bowl 10 overs.

The role of a fast bowling all-rounder, a rare commodity in Indian cricket, has gained more significance ahead of the World Cup in South Africa next year.

Gambhir was happy with how Nitish bowled in his comeback T20 against Afghanistan, taking three wickets in the final game

on Thursday. He has also been withdrawn from the Asian Games T20 squad so that he can focus on ODIs.

"No, first of all, from Nitish's point of view, it's actually a great thing that he's been withdrawn from T20 format, and he'll get game time against the West Indies as well. We know how important seam bowling all-rounders will be, probably in a year's time when we go to South Africa," said Gambhir in the post series media interaction.

Cautions against rushing Pandya back

The head coach cautioned against rushing Pandya back to international cricket. The injury-prone all-rounder will have to prove his match fitness in the A series against Australia next month at Puducherry.

"And once Hardik comes back, obviously, it's going to be

good. Sometimes, we could even go on to play both (Pandya and Reddy) of them in the playing eleven. But, again, Hardik at the moment, yes, he cannot bowl 10 overs, and he hasn't played a lot of cricket since the IPL. So, we don't want to push him into international cricket, because international cricket can be extremely tough on your body as well.

"So, if he plays those, that India A series, obviously, he'll get some game time as well. And that was the clear message to him, that if he can play that A series, and then if everything goes well, he can come back

and be a part of the T20s and the one-day squad as well."

Offers Nitish game time

Gambhir also thought that the scenario will help Nitish to get more game time.

"In the meantime, Nitish will get more game time as well, because he hasn't played enough cricket since the IPL either. So, I think it's good that we've got Nitish now from the Asian Games, and you could see, the more he bowls, the better he becomes.

"And when you can develop a couple of seam bowling all-rounders, it will always be handy in a year's time (for the World Cup)."

Nitish conceded 15 runs after he was asked to bowl the first over of Afghanistan innings on Thursday. He bounced back to take three wickets in India's handsome victory, and he had taken three wickets even in the

second T20I.

"It's been a huge plus for us because we want to expose him to most of the international games, because we know how important he is. Whether it's in the 50-over format or going forward in T20s as well, because there are not many going around — guys who can bowl and who can bat in the middle-order.

"So it's a massive positive, the way he's bowled in this series. Obviously, he didn't start off that well in the first game, but then we always know that the more you bowl in international cricket, the more you're going to get better, and that's what he's shown today," Gambhir added. pn



Hardik Pandya.
PHOTO: THE HINDU

ICC eyes China in bid to expand cricket

China became a focus market after hosting cricket at the 2022 Asian Games in Hangzhou

NEW DELHI: China is emerging as a key target for growth as the International Cricket Council (ICC) seeks new fans worldwide, its chief executive says.

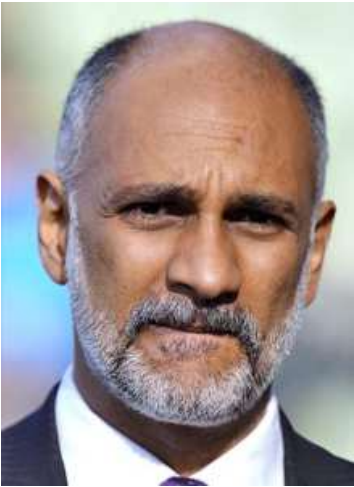
While South Asia accounts for about 90% of cricket's billion-plus fans, the ICC is seeking to expand the sport's fan base by 500 million and sees China's 1.4 billion people as a potentially huge audience — helped by the steady progress of its women's team.

"The continued success of their women's team has provided a major boost to cricket in the country," ICC chief executive Sanjog Gupta said.

China became a focus market after hosting cricket at the 2022 Asian Games in Hangzhou and through the progress of its women's national team, which has climbed 10 places in the world rankings over the past two years.

There is still far to go, however. In the ICC T20 rankings the women are ranked a modest 36th, while the men languish in 92nd place.

The women were also knocked out of the Asian Games on Thursday without a ball being bowled. A **sudden** (thoroughly soaked) outfield caused by days of rain in Nagoya, Japan, prevented any play from taking place in China's morning quarter-final against Bangladesh, who went



ICC chief executive Sanjog Gupta.
FILE PHOTO: MIKE EGERTON/PA
IMAGES VIA GETTY IMAGES

through to the semi-finals by virtue of being the higher.

Still, China is one of several markets the ICC sees as crucial to broadening cricket's appeal beyond its traditional strongholds of South Asia, England, and Australia.

"Next leap"

The ICC has spent \$1.5 million in China to boost the sport over the past five years.

The country now has three top-level cricket venues, including a new 1,500-seat stadium in Taicang expected to host domestic and international matches and provide a training base for the national teams.

Some women's T20 World Cup matches were broadcast in Mandarin, and the final week of the 2026 men's T20 World Cup

"The continued success of their women's team has provided a major boost to cricket in the country

generated 4.4 million video views in China. The country's potential emergence is particularly significant for the ICC because, unlike several newer cricket nations, its men's and women's teams are made up largely of home-grown players rather than players from South Asian communities.

Indonesia, a country of around 280 million people, has also been identified as a market with growth potential.

"If even segments of the population in China and Indonesia start engaging with the sport, then they could power the next leap in the scale of cricket's fandom," Gupta said.

"It can play a significant role in the sport's ambition to add 500 million fans to its global fan base, which is the ICC chair's stated ambition."

Return to Olympics

The ICC believes cricket's return to the Olympics at the 2028 Los Angeles Games could provide another boost, with men's and women's T20 tournaments set to award medals for the first time since the sport's lone previous appearance in 1900.

The ICC push has the backing of the Marylebone Cricket Club (MCC), custodian of the game's laws. AFP

Teenager Sullivan named in new-look US squad

LOS ANGELES, U.S.: Sixteen-year-old talent Cavan Sullivan was named in a new-look United States squad on Thursday as head coach Mauricio Pochettino begins the long journey to the 2030 World Cup.

Philadelphia Union phenomenon Sullivan, who turns 17 on September 28, is one of eight teenagers included in Pochettino's 28-man **roster** (a list, especially of the names of players on a sports team) for friendlies against Peru, Chile, Mexico and Canada.

Talented young prospect

Sullivan is widely regarded as the most talented young prospect in US football and has already signed an agreement which will see the attacking midfielder join English Premier League giants Manchester City when he turns 18 next year.

Pochettino said on Thursday that Sullivan's elevation to the senior US squad was well-deserved following a string of impressive performances in Major League Soccer, where he has scored six goals with nine assists in 16 starts.

"He deserves all the praise he's getting, because he's performing well, playing well, giving assists and scoring goals," Pochettino said.

"He's only 16, he's a kid"

"He's only 16, he's a kid, but I think the most important thing is that we have the opportunity now to work with him in the national team, the



Sixteen-year-old Cavan Sullivan.
PHOTO: REUTERS

FIND OUT

1) How many teenagers have been included in Pochettino's 28-man roster for the upcoming friendlies?

2) Cavan Sullivan will join which English Premier League club once he turns 18?

possibility to talk and to share ideas.

"He's special because he's 16 and playing at this level in MLS... Now it's another challenge because international competition is a different level.

"The most important thing is that we need to have a clear idea how to provide him with the best platform to evolve every day."

Pochettino last month signed a contract extension which will see him remain as US head coach through the 2030 World Cup. It follows a successful 2026 World Cup campaign which saw his team reach the last 16.

Thirteen members of Pochettino's World Cup squad have been included in the squad for the upcoming friendlies.

Several notable members of the USA's World Cup campaign, including Christian Pulisic and Folarin Balogun, are absent as they recover from injuries.

The United States open their international fixtures against Peru on September 26 at Orlando, Florida. AFP

TRUMP THEM

Using the newspaper as a tool, enhance your learning process. Pick images of two individual sports stars in our sports page today and create your own trump cards!

Fill up the player's name and the parameters on the left side column (height, weight, date of birth and matches played) for both cards as these are common parameters regardless of the sport they play.

For the column on the right, pick and choose the parameters that you want to fill in. For instance, it could be four of runs, batting average, strike rate, wickets, bowling average, economy rate, and catches for cricketers. In tennis, it could be four of highest ranking achieved, current ranking, titles won, grand slam titles won, aces served, etc. In football, you could be picking from goals, assists, clean sheets, red cards, yellow cards, and more. And in basketball, choose four from points, assists, rebounds, steals, and blocks.

Feel free to choose any four parameters in each sport. But once you've selected them, stick to the same every time you fill in player details for players in the same sport. This is important if you want to use them as trump cards.

Once you have filled in all the details, cut out both completed cards from the newspaper and stick it on to chart paper of the same size. This way, they will retain shape and not be too flimsy. When you have created enough cards for any single sport, you will be able to use them all as trump cards and play with your friends or family members.

	
Name	
Height (cm)	
Weight (kg)	
Date of birth	
Matches played	

	
Name	
Height (cm)	
Weight (kg)	
Date of birth	
Matches played	